US macroeconomic outlook

10 OCTOBER 2026 | CWT MACRO AGENT ASSESSMENT
Official-source context; separate from the synthetic demonstration.

Working interpretation: Resilient demand, persistent inflation and subdued hiring create competing risks for monetary policy.

Inflation remains above target

August CPI rose 0.4% month over month and 3.4% year over year; core CPI rose 0.3% monthly and 2.4% annually. Energy contributed to headline pressure. September CPI was not yet available at the cutoff and is scheduled for 14 October. [1]

Hiring momentum is limited

September payrolls increased by 29,000, unemployment was 4.2%, and annual hourly-earnings growth was 3.0%. July/August revisions reduced combined job gains by 60,000. This supports caution about labour demand; one report does not establish a recession. [2]

Policy faces an inflation-growth tension

The FOMC raised its target range by 25 basis points to 3.75%-4.00% on 16 September, citing elevated inflation. Persistent price pressure and restrained hiring pull policy considerations in different directions. [3]

Demand is resilient, purchasing power less so

Q2 real GDP grew at a 2.2% annualized rate in the third estimate, versus 1.5% previously. August real spending rose 0.6% monthly while real disposable income was flat. Annual headline/core PCE inflation was 3.4%/3.0%. [4,5]

Forward view - analytical inference

Continued expansion with inflation above the Fed goal is a reasonable base scenario, with hiring weakness a downside risk. Hotter inflation could raise rate pressure; weaker jobs/spending could shift focus toward growth risk. Market reactions depend on expectations and positioning. Watch the next CPI and 29 October GDP/PCE releases; their outcomes are unknown.

Implication for the pipeline

Use actual-versus-consensus surprises only after publication; retain original snapshots, revisions and collection times. These verified headline levels do not replace missing consensus forecasts or historical vintages. This briefing is not evidence of Tavily execution or real trading performance.

Sources checked at the stated cutoff

[1] BLS: August CPI, released 11 September 2026
[2] BLS: September employment, released 2 October 2026
[3] Federal Reserve: FOMC statement, 16 September 2026
[4] BEA: Q2 GDP third estimate, 30 September 2026
[5] BEA: August income and outlays, 30 September 2026